

	Excellent (HD) >85%	Good (D) 75%-84%	Acceptable (C) 65%-74%	Poor (P) 50%-64%	Insufficient (F) <50%
INTRODUCTION (15%)	Excellent <i>Introduction clearly describes the clip, accurately identifies the claims being made, and provides broader social/psychological context for the topic.</i>	Good <i>Clearly describes the clip and identifies the claims being made. Gives some thought to the relevance of the topic.</i>	Acceptable <i>Describes clip and accurately identifies the claims being made.</i>	Poor <i>Attempts to describe the clip and the claims being made. May be off-topic or unclear.</i>	Insufficient <i>Little to no attempt to describe the clip. Inaccurate identification of argument. No context.</i>
THESIS STATEMENT (5%)	Excellent <i>Clear and original thesis statement that includes a coherent argument and an accurate outline of the points to be made in the essay.</i>	Good <i>Clear thesis statement that includes an argument and an outline of the points to be made in the essay.</i>	Acceptable <i>Provides a general argument and attempts to outline the structure of the essay.</i>	Poor <i>Vague attempt to outline the essay or the argument.</i>	Insufficient <i>No thesis statement included.</i>
TOPIC (15%)	Excellent <i>Body of the essay identifies scientific literature that was a likely source for the original claim AND scientific literature or analysis that offers a thoughtful counterargument to the original claim.</i>	Good <i>Body of the essay identifies scientific literature that supports the original claim AND scientific literature that contradicts the original claim.</i>	Acceptable <i>Body of the essay identifies scientific literature to support and contradict original claim. Some evidence may be tangential or unrelated.</i>	Poor <i>Scientific literature is discussed but not clearly related to the topic. May include references to non-scientific literature.</i>	Insufficient <i>References are off topic and/or largely from non-scientific literature.</i>
ANALYSIS (15%)	Excellent <i>Methods and results of scientific studies are clearly and accurately explained with an appropriate level of detail. Thoughtful and insightful interpretation of results.</i>	Good <i>Methods and results of scientific studies are clearly and accurately explained with an appropriate level of detail. Accurate interpretation of results.</i>	Acceptable <i>Methods and results are partially described. Accurate interpretation of the findings.</i>	Poor <i>No attempt to describe methodology or specific results. Broad interpretation with little analysis.</i>	Insufficient <i>No attempt to describe methodology or results. May rely on non-scientific literature, or interpretation may be inaccurate.</i>
ARGUMENT (20%)	Excellent <i>Argument is cohesive, insightful, and supported by the literature. Includes a thoughtful discussion of supporting and opposing evidence.</i>	Good <i>Argument is clearly stated, consistent, and supported by the evidence.</i>	Acceptable <i>Argument is identifiable and generally supported by the evidence.</i>	Poor <i>Argument is difficult to identify, inconsistent, and/or not supported by the evidence.</i>	Insufficient <i>No argument presented.</i>
COMMUNICATION (10%)	Excellent <i>Writing is clear and well-structured, with minimal grammatical errors. Professional academic style that doesn't over-use jargon. Explains complex ideas with accuracy and clarity.</i>	Good <i>Writing is clear and well-structured, with minimal grammatical errors. Uses professional academic writing.</i>	Acceptable <i>Writing is generally easy to follow and mostly uses professional academic writing. May include some grammatical errors, excessive jargon, or be overly reliant on AI.</i>	Poor <i>Writing is difficult to follow and lacks a cohesive structure.</i>	Insufficient <i>No structure, below expected word count, difficult to read.</i>
CONCLUSION (10%)	Excellent <i>Clear and concise summary of the main points of the essay. Brings the argument together and provides a natural ending. Does not introduce new information.</i>	Good <i>Clear and concise summary of essay. Provides a natural ending. Does not introduce new information.</i>	Acceptable <i>Accurate summary of some of the main points. Provides a clear end to the essay.</i>	Poor <i>Conclusion includes new information, is overly broad, and/or doesn't accurately summarise the argument.</i>	Insufficient <i>No conclusion provided.</i>
REFERENCING (10%) APA-formatted reference list including all references used in the testimony. https://www.library.sydney.edu.au/support/referencing/apa	Excellent <i>Accurate use of APA-formatting for in-text citations and reference list. No errors. Appropriate literature used.</i>	Good <i>Accurate use of APA-formatting for in-text citations and reference list. May have a few minor errors. Appropriate literature used.</i>	Acceptable <i>Generally accurate use of APA-formatting for in-text citations and reference list.</i>	Poor <i>Poor use of APA-formatting for in-text citations and/or reference list. Multiple errors, missed citations, and/or inappropriate literature.</i>	Insufficient <i>No references provided.</i>